



Retail Vendor Evaluations

GOALS

- **EVALUATE WHICH VENDORS WERE A GOOD FIT**
- **LOOK AT OPTIONS FOR SMOKEOUT 2026**
 - **KEEP THE RETAIL SPLIT (80/20)**
 - **HAVE RETAILERS PAY BASE FEE AND THEY KEEP THE PROFITS**
- **LOOK AT SALES/SOCIAL DATA TO FIND COMMON TRENDS**

OUTLIERS

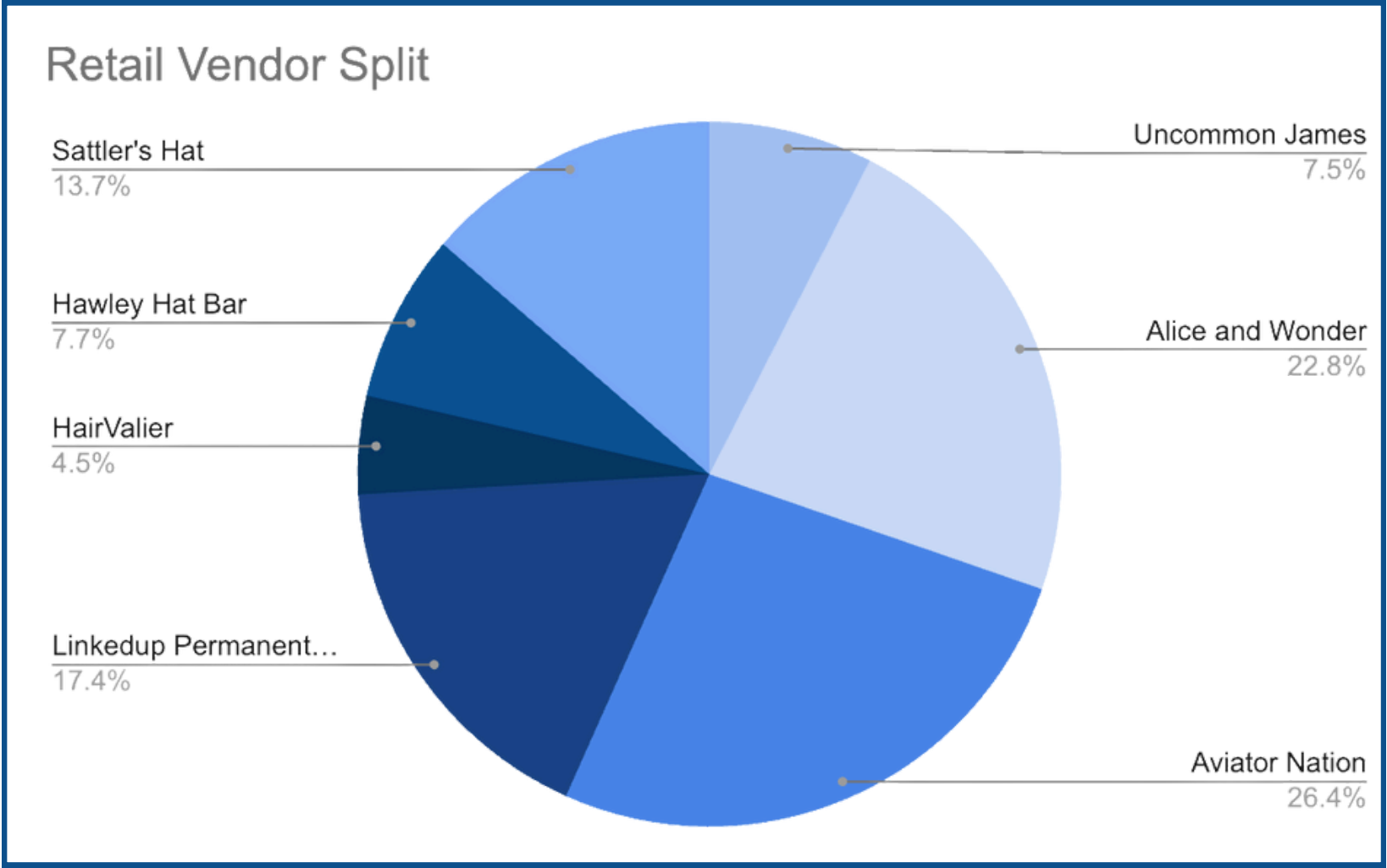
- **WEATHER**
- **POS NOT WORKING/NOT RECIEVED UNTIL DURING FESTIVAL**

DATA ANALYSIS & TREND FORECASTING

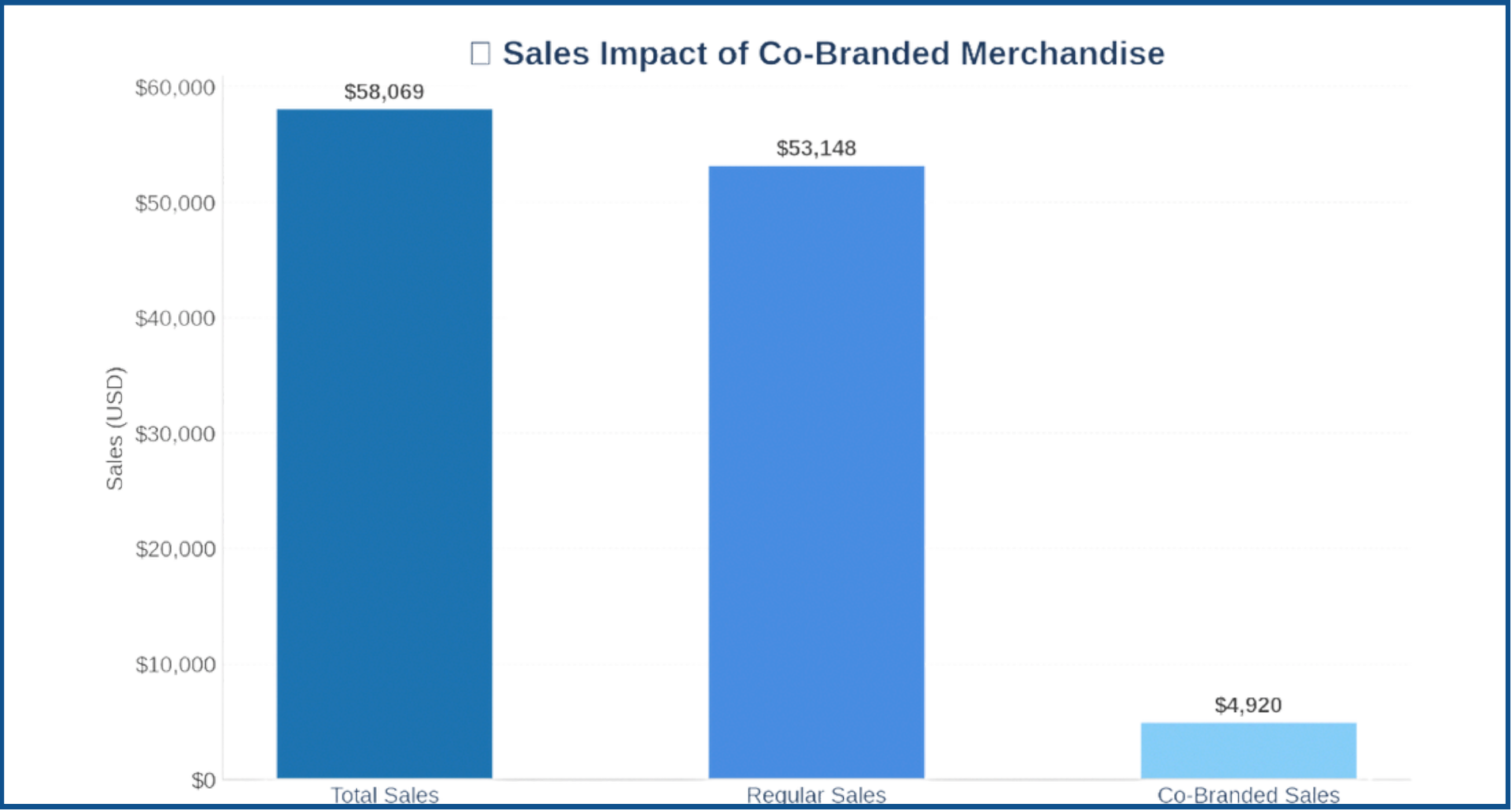
SALES DATA

- **Average weekend sales: \$36,463.26**
- **Windy City Smokeout Profit: \$44,295.41**
- **Highest/lowest range: \$11,505.08– \$67,368.11**
- **Average social impressions per retailer post or tag: X,XXX**
- **Number of festival attendees: 100,000**
- **Foot traffic per retailer: ~4,286 per retailer**
 - **Not everyone stops by rodeo drive, If 30% of attendees visit retail activations, then:**
 - **$100,000 \times .3 = 30,000 / 7 = \sim 4,286$ people**

GRAPHS



VENDOR RETAIL SPLIT



CO-BRANDED SALES
***Alice & Wonder**

TRENDS

- 1. People love clothes the most!**
- 2. IG Videos/Reels is the best for marketing.**
- 3. Jewelry performs better than hair.**

INDIVIDUAL RETAILER PERFORMANCE

AVIATOR NATION

MULTIPLE LOCATIONS | 1st in sales

TOTAL WEEKEND SALES: \$67,368.11 | 90/10 split

PROS

- **High Demand Product – Custom merchandise aligns perfectly with festival**
- **Fast & Accessible – Quick boutique pop-up set up makes it easy for more guests to purchase**

CONS

- **Price – Premium pricing may limit sales volume, especially among GA festival attendees.**

RECCOMENDATION

- 1. Kill it every year with custom merch**
- 2. Bring back the pink [so many people mentioned it!]**
- 3. great for VIP, Platinum, and more expensive sections**
- 4. Add a foldable try-on area somewhere**

ALICE & WONDER

NEW VENDOR | 2nd in sales

TOTAL WEEKEND SALES: \$58,068.65 | 80/20 split

AVERAGE SALES PER-DAY: \$14,517 per-day

PROS

- **High Demand Product – Custom cowboy hats align perfectly with the country/western theme**
- **Fast & Accessible – Quick boutique pop-up set up and approachable pricing make it easy for more guests to purchase**

CONS

- **Longer Transaction Time – Custom hat-making or apparel sizing can slow down sales during busy festival periods**

RECCOMENDATION

- 1. Perfect retail vendor for Smokeout [find alternative for LSS]**
- 2. They have a strong socials presence make a collab video or post**
 - a. look at the one they released with the Cubs for inspo**

LINKEDUP JEWELRY

TOP JEWELRY SELLER | 3RD in sales

TOTAL WEEKEND SALES: \$44,407.95 | 80/20 split

AVERAGE SALES PER-DAY: \$11,101.99 per-day

PROS

- **Product:** Permanent jewelry is all the hype right now and is perfect for festival
- **Quick Setup & High Volume:** Service only takes around 5-10 minutes meaning they could see multiple customers a day
- **Strong Customer Loyalty:** The personalized nature of permanent jewelry fosters repeat business and brand loyalty.

CONS

- **Lower Price Point:** The pricing structure may limit total revenue per transaction compared to premium vendors.
- **High Engagement –** Personal service creates memorable moments, especially for female guests

RECCOMENDATION

- 1. Killed it permanent jewelry is the new trend**
- 2. Bring them back with more custom charm options**

SATTTLERS HAT

MOST AFFORDABLE | 4TH in sales

TOTAL WEEKEND SALES: \$34,900.00 | 80/20 split

AVERAGE SALES PER-DAY: \$8,725 per-day

PROS

- **High Demand Product – Custom cowboy hats align perfectly with the country/western theme**
- **Fast & Accessible – Quick setup and approachable pricing make it easy for more guests to purchase**

CONS

- **Less Customization – Compared to interactive hat bars, the experience is simpler**
- **Lower Price Point – Limits total revenue per transaction compared to premium vendors**
- **Location - at end of Rodeo Drive**

RECCOMENDATION

- 1. Keep them for affordable option**
- 2. Put them where Hawley was this year since is an eye-sore at the end of Rodeo Drive. Would be better closer to stage as well.**

HAWLEY HAT BAR

Trucker Hats | 5TH in sales

TOTAL WEEKEND SALES: \$19,754.00 | 80/20 split

PROS

- **Interactive Experience – Customizable hat bar draws in guests looking for something unique**
- **Premium Product – Higher price point adds to perceived value and aligns with vibe**

CONS

- **Limited Visibility – Not located directly on Rodeo Drive, likely impacted foot traffic and sales**
- **Category Overlap – Competes with Alice & Wonder (also selling baseball hats) in a similar style and category**

RECCOMENDATION

- 1. Do you need two hat bars when Alice & Wonder also come with benefit of clothing as well?**
- 2. Have Hawley be solely LSS and Alice & Wonder be solely WCS**

UNCOMMON JAMES

Western-style | 6TH in sales

TOTAL WEEKEND SALES: \$19,239.00 | 80/20 split

AVERAGE SALES PER-DAY: \$4,809.75 per-day

PROS

- **Recognizable Brand – Celebrity-backed and known name adds perceived value**
- **Trendy, Giftable Product – Jewelry is easy to buy, wear, or gift on-site**

CONS

- **Category Overlap – Directly competes with Kendra Scott, a stronger and more established brand at the fest**
- **Lower Differentiation – Product and price point are similar, making it harder to stand out in a crowded category**

RECCOMENDATION

1. Kendra Scott is more with current demographic of festival do not need to over-populate rodeo drive area.

HAIRVALIER

Accesories | 7th in sales

TOTAL WEEKEND SALES: \$10,777.53 | 80/20 split

PROS

- **Unique Activation – On-site braiding offers something different from typical merch**
- **High Engagement – Personal service creates memorable moments, especially for female guests**

CONS

- **Lower Sales Volume – Only generated ~\$11.5K, below most other retailers**
- **Slower TurnoverTime – intensive service limits number of transactions**
- **Limited Fit for Demographic – Hair braiding may not strongly resonate with core country/BBQ festival audience**

RECCOMENDATION

- 1. what they sell isn't as popular anymore. They aren't competing well when against other vendors.**
- 2. put them in artist or cabana area as elevated option instead of on rodeo drive.**

RETAILER COMPARISONS

ALICE & WONDER VS. AVIATOR NATION

1. Product Focus

- a. Aviator Nation: Premium apparel, higher price point**
- b. Alice & Wonder: Trendy lifestyle merch + branded baseball hats**

2. Audience & Price Point

- a. Aviator Nation = upscale shopper, higher spend**
- b. Alice & Wonder = broad appeal, budget-friendly, high volume**

3. Category Redundancy

- a. Both sell lifestyle apparel with festival branding**
- b. Alice & Wonder and Hawley both offered baseball hats**

4. Guest Experience

- a. Aviator Nation = multi-location, polished presence (VIP, Platinum areas)**
- b. Alice & Wonder = single booth, accessible and fast-moving**

5. Recommendation

- a. Keep both – they serve different audience segments**
- b. Aviator Nation is ideal for premium spaces like VIP/Platinum**
- c. Alice & Wonder drives volume and engagement in general areas**

SATTTLERS VS. HAWLEY HAT BAR

1. Product Focus

- a. Sattler's: Custom cowboy hats**
- b. Hawley: Custom baseball hats**

2. Audience & Price Point

- a. Sattler's = western, festival-aligned, broader appeal**
- b. Hawley = boutique, higher price, slower volume**

3. Guest Experience

- a. Sattler's = fast, accessible option**
- b. Hawley = custom bar, longer interaction**

4. Recommendation

- a. Consider limiting to one baseball hat vendor**
- b. Retain Sattler's for western fit and volume**

MODEL ANALYSIS

MODEL 1: BASE PRICE

- **RETAILER PAYS \$XXX UPFRONT**
[RANGE BASED ON PAST PERFORMANCE/PRODUCT TYPE]
- **KEEPS ALL SALES REVENUE**

PROS

- **GURANTEED REVENUE UPFRONT**
- **NO DEPENDENCE ON PERFORMANCE**
- **OPPORTUNITY FOR TIER PRICING**
 - **CHARGE MORE FOR HIGH-TRAFFIC**
 - **LOCATIONS OR PREMIUM SET-UP**
 - **CAN CREATE AN EARLY BIRD RATE**
- **LESS BACK-AND-FORTH**
- **PREDICTABLE BUDGETING**
- **MINIMUM REVENUE PROTECTION**

CONS

- **MISSING UPSIDE POTENTIAL**
- **POTENTIAL PERCIEVED LACK OF VALUE (PRESSURE TO DELIVER)**
 - **“WHAT AM I GETTING FOR THIS FEE”**
- **NO POST-EVENT DATA CAPTURE**
- **DIFFICULT TO JUSTIFY PRICE CHANGES YEAR TO YEAR WITHOUT SALES PROOF**

HIGH SALES VENDOR (\$35,000 or more)

YES

- **Proven Sales**
 - Likely to beat base fee and profit
- **Predictable ROI**
 - Easy to plan and budget
- **Strong Brand**
 - Fans will buy regardless
- **Perks**
 - Upfront pay often means better placement and promo

NO

- **Missed Profit**
 - Flat fee limits earnings on big sales
- **No Upside**
 - Festival revenue stays the same
- **Less Transparency**
 - No incentive to report sales
- **No Growth Share**
 - Vendor wins big, festival doesn't

LOW SALES VENDOR (\$20,000 or less)

YES

- **Low Stakes**
 - Small base fee could still be manageable
- **Brand Boost**
 - Co-branding helps them gain exposure
- **Extra Support**
 - Can be bundled with marketing or placement perks
- **Growth Opportunity**
 - Good test if they want to scale up
 -

NO

- **Tight Margins**
 - Base fee cuts deep into profit
- **Cash Flow Risk**
 - Hard to front money with no guaranteed return
- **Low Volume**
 - Harder to sell enough to justify cost
- **Higher Pressure**
 - Adds stress for smaller teams or first-timers

BASE PRICE MODEL IN ACTION

IN THIS MODEL RETAILER PAYS SAME BASE WHICH IS **\$7,500**

POTENTIAL IMPACT

using 2025 retailer numbers

7 RETAILERS

\$7,500

7

X 7,500

+\$52,500

POTENTIAL IMPACT

2025 WCS PROFIT

\$42,502.96

Difference:

$$\text{\$52,500} - \text{\$42,502.96} = \text{\$9,997.04}$$

Percentage Increase:

$$\frac{\text{\$52,500} - \text{\$42,502.96}}{\text{\$42,502.96}} = \frac{\text{\$9,997.04}}{\text{\$42,502.96}} \times 100 = \text{23.5\% increase}$$

MODEL 2: RETAIL REV SHARE

- **NO UPFRONT FEE**
- **CURRENTLY: FESTIVAL KEEPS 20% OF SALES**
- **RETAILER KEEPS 80%**

PROS

- **LOW BARRIER TO ENTRY**
- **ATTRACTS MORE VENDORS**
- **SCALES WITH PERFORMANCE**
 - **MORE SALES = MORE REVENUE**
- **ENCOURAGES FULL REPORTING**
 - **VENDORS MUST TRACK SALES**
- **SIMPLE TO MANAGE**
 - **ONE STANDARD SPLIT ACROSS ALL**
- **GREAT FOR TESTING NEW OR SMALL VENDORS**

CONS

- **NO GUARANTEED REVENUE**
 - **RISK IF SALES ARE LOW**
- **LOWER PROFIT CEILING**
 - **HIGH SELLERS MIGHT NET MORE UNDER A BASE OR HYBRID MODEL**
- **HARDER TO JUSTIFY PERKS**
 - **PLACEMENT, PROMO, ETC. MAY FEEL ONE-SIDED**

WHAT IS THE BEST RETAIL SPLIT?

80/20?

70/30?

60/40?

WHY 70/30 IS THE BEST RETAIL SPLIT:

- It boosts revenue for the festival by over \$25K without significantly burdening vendors.
- Still vendor-friendly: brands keep 70% of sales, which is generous given the exposure.
- Keeps operations simple with one consistent split (vs. confusing tiered models).
- Fair exchange: vendors get access to 100K+ attendees, high visibility, and strong sales potential.

HOW TO EXPLAIN THE CHANGE:

“We’ve adjusted our retail split to 70/30 to better support the growth of the festival while still offering a valuable platform for your brand. You’ll continue to keep the majority of your sales, and in return, we’re investing even more in driving foot traffic, marketing exposure, and premium placement to help you maximize your revenue.”

POTENTIAL IMPACT

using 2025 numbers if every vendor was 80/20 split

CURRENT 80/20

\$51,048.56

WITH 70/30

\$76,572.84

+25,524.28

MODEL 3: HYBRID CO-BRANDED

- **RETAILER PAYS \$XXX UPFRONT**
- **WCS GETS % OF NET CO-BRANDED MERCH SALES**

PROS

- **PASSIVE INCOME POTENTIAL FROM MINIMAL ONGOING EFFORT**
- **SHARED MERCH = SHARED MARKETING**
- **POTENTIAL FOR HIGHER TOTAL REVENUE**
- **DRIVES EXCLUSIVITY & FAN EXCITEMENT**
- **EASIER TO JUSTIFY HIGHER PRICE POINTS**
- **FLEXIBLE MARGINS – CAN NEGOTIATE % SPLIT BASED ON INVESTMENT**

CONS

- **MORE COMPLEX TO MANAGE INVENTORY & SPLIT**
- **RISK IF MERCH DOESN'T SELL**
- **HARDER TO SCALE WITH MULTIPLE VENDORS**
- **MAY DISTRACT FROM VENDOR'S CORE PRODUCT SALES**
- **NOT ALL VENDORS HAVE THE BRAND STRENGTH TO MOVE CO-BRANDED ITEMS**

ALICE & WONDER

WCS 2025 NEW TOP SUCCESS

- **Adds \$4.9K in Extra Sales**
 - **Co-branded merch brought in ~10% more without hurting regular sales.**
 - **Co-branded alone made more profits than what WCS made from Hawley Hat Bar & HairValier combined (~\$4,200)**
- **New Revenue Stream**
 - **We both make money beyond the standard split.**
- **More Brand Love**
 - **Both WCS and the vendor get exposure from shared designs + promo.**
- **People Want It**
 - **Limited-edition stuff sells – fans are into exclusive drops.**
- **Low Risk, High Reward**
 - **Easy to repeat and brings in extra income.**

THE END